A2 - Oral Mediation 4: Learning Sequence

Before starting the mediation activity, ask students to read the task and the price list carefully to make the aim of the activity clear.

At the Market

You are spending Saturday morning visiting a local market with your English-speaking friend Sarah, who is visiting Spain for the first time. Sarah doesn't speak any Spanish and feels a bit nervous about shopping at the market. She wants to buy some fresh fruit and vegetables to cook a healthy dinner tonight, but she doesn't understand the prices, the special offers or what the vendor is saying. The vendor is speaking quickly in Spanish and using hand gestures, which is making Sarah more confused. You want to help Sarah understand the price list, so she can buy what she needs.



FRESH FRUIT & VEGETABLES



Apples €2.50/kg



Bananas €1.80/kg



Oranges €2.00/kg



Tomatoes €3.20/kg



Carrots €1.50/kg



Cucumber €2.80/kg



Lettuce €1.20/kg



Peppers €3.50/kg

SPECIAL OFFERS TODAY!

- **Buy 2 kg of any fruit → Get 10% discount**
- **Mixed vegetable bag (1 kg) → Only €5.00**

VENDOR'S RECOMMENDATIONS

Make your own salad:
FRESH TOMATOES
FRESH PEPPERS

Healthy snack:
SWEET APPLES

You have ten minutes to prepare the task. Your explanation should last between 2.30 to 3 minutes. You need to:

- Explain the prices and special offers to Sarah
- Tell Sarah what the vendor recommends
- Help Sarah decide what to buy

One of you will play the role of Sarah who is not sure about what to buy



In oral mediation, you need to understand the material (the price list) and then explain it in a clear and useful way. Read all the information carefully (prices, special offers and recommendations) and explain it in your own words using simple, friendly language.

Make sure it is clear why you are talking about the topic. Refer to the context (you are at the market helping your friend Sarah).

Refer to the price list you have been given, but do not read it aloud. Paraphrase the information and make it easy for your friend to understand.

Let's get ready!

1. Analyse the task

a. Read the task carefully and answer these questions. They will help you choose the register of the mediation task.

   a) Who is going to be talking and who will receive the message?

   b) Why does Sarah need your help?

   c) What information does Sarah need to understand?

b. After analysing the task, choose the correct answer.

   a) In this mediation task, I have to use formal / informal register.

   b) The addressee is the person who sends / receives the message.

   c) I have to give Sarah all the information she needs / only the prices.

2. Analyse the information

Read the information on the price list carefully.

   a) What is the important information on the price list that your friend Sarah needs to know?

   b) Underline the ideas that you think can be most helpful to explain to Sarah and help her buy the best products.

Let's prepare the language!

1. Discuss the main ideas

1. Read this text where a person is explaining prices and recommendations at a market. Underline all the expressions he or she uses to talk about prices and give suggestions.

I went to the market yesterday. I found some good things to buy. The apples cost €2.50 per kilo. This is a good price. The vendor told me the tomatoes were very fresh, so I bought some. There was a special offer: buy two kilos of fruit and get a discount. I think this is a good way to save money. The vendor told me to try the peppers. They are good for salads. I bought some carrots, too. They were cheap – only €1.50 per kilo. I think it is better to buy vegetables when they are in season. They are fresher and cheaper.

Other Useful Language

It's €… per kilo/ unit
It's a good idea to…
Why don't you … ?
There's a discount
There's a special offer
fresh / cheap

Do not use the same expressions all the time. Add new words to your vocabulary and you will see that you express yourself a lot better.



2. Imagine you have to explain several things. Put the following words in the order they should be used.

Finally	First	Then

1. First 2. Then 3. Finally

2. Give reasons and examples

1. Give a reason and an example that support each of the statements below.

a) I think you should buy the mixed vegetable bag.

b) The tomatoes are a good choice today.

Let's mediate!

Make sure students understand the task and you can summarise the tips below.

You are spending Saturday morning visiting a local market with your English-speaking friend Sarah, who is visiting Spain for the first time. Sarah doesn't speak any Spanish and feels a bit nervous about shopping at the market. She wants to buy some fresh fruit and vegetables to cook a healthy dinner tonight, but she doesn't understand the prices, the special offers or what the vendor is saying. The vendor is speaking quickly in Spanish and using hand gestures, which is making Sarah more confused. You want to help Sarah understand the price list, so she can buy what she needs.

1. Content

Content

Look at the price list on page 1 and read the information there carefully again. Select the information you are going to tell your friend Sarah.
You can use the following questions:

- Which products have the best prices and which ones are more expensive?
  Best prices (cheapest): **More expensive:**
- How can Sarah save money with the special offers?
- What products would be good for making a healthy dinner?

2. Language

Language

Use your own words. Simplify or paraphrase the information.

Remember to adapt your register to the task and addressee.

Vary the language you use. Look at the Other Useful Language on page 3.

Use expressions to talk about prices, give recommendations and explain offers.